they fear for their jobs?' The common Vale management practice of dismissing workers without due cause meant that all bets were off. Why put your head up to fight for a safe workplace if doing so can cost you your livelihood?

While visiting Vale's largest iron ore mine in Carajás, in the Amazon jungle, we were shown a 'state of the art' central control where operators can monitor the performance of equipment, from bearing and engine temperatures to speeds of hauling trucks, all designed to improve productivity. This all looked great until we toured the mine site and saw employees wearing paper dust masks, like those banned in Canada because they offer little or no protection. When talking to our union brothers, we found that they were not aware of basic programmes, such as Work Place Environmental Monitoring or ensuring respirators are appropriate for the task and properly fitted. This leads one to ask where Vale's priorities are, which must be production over safety (Anderson 2006).

The post-conference trip to Sudbury for the international delegates gave the Sudbury Vale workers an opportunity to explain how the company actually took advantage of the lengthy strike situation in Canada to introduce a new top-down health and safety programme, with language making it even more 'behaviour-based', i.e. with the explicit assumption that workers' behaviour – ignorance, carelessness, inattention and the like – is the main cause of workplace accidents and fatalities. Policies were introduced to give management an even stronger disciplinary hand. Mechanisms that had built up serious worker involvement and responsibility were gutted, like Form 079, which allowed and encouraged any worker anywhere, at any time to report on concerns, incidents and accidents. Another change that shifted the dynamic in a negative way was a new rule that made bonus pay calculable only for 'face time', i.e. time spent actually in production working on the rock face. Down time because of a safety concern or a safety incident meant that people were not getting those hours included in their bonus calculations, a guaranteed mechanism to encourage workers themselves to become more lax.

The USW report on the double fatality at the Frood-Stobie mine in Sudbury on 8 July 2011 captures all of the problems with Vale's approach. Two young workers, one in a supervisory role, were fatally injured while working on an ore pass about 900 metres below the surface. Management had been alerted several times previously of the danger of a build-up in that area. When the workers opened the door to check the flow from one level to another, they were buried in an avalanche of wet muck (*Sudbury Star* 2011).

After the accident, Vale said that it wanted a joint investigation – but it also wanted full control, the right to lead the investigation, the right to limit the scope